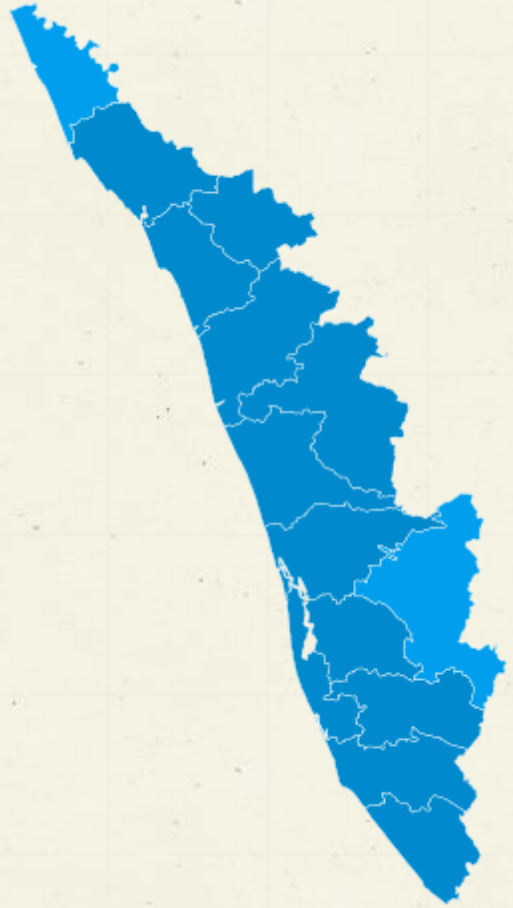
Kerala's E-Waste Landscape

Navigating hazardous waste streams, urban mining potential, and the path to a circular economy (FY 2025-26).



Kerala State Pollution Control Board

The Paradox of Digital Waste

The Hazard

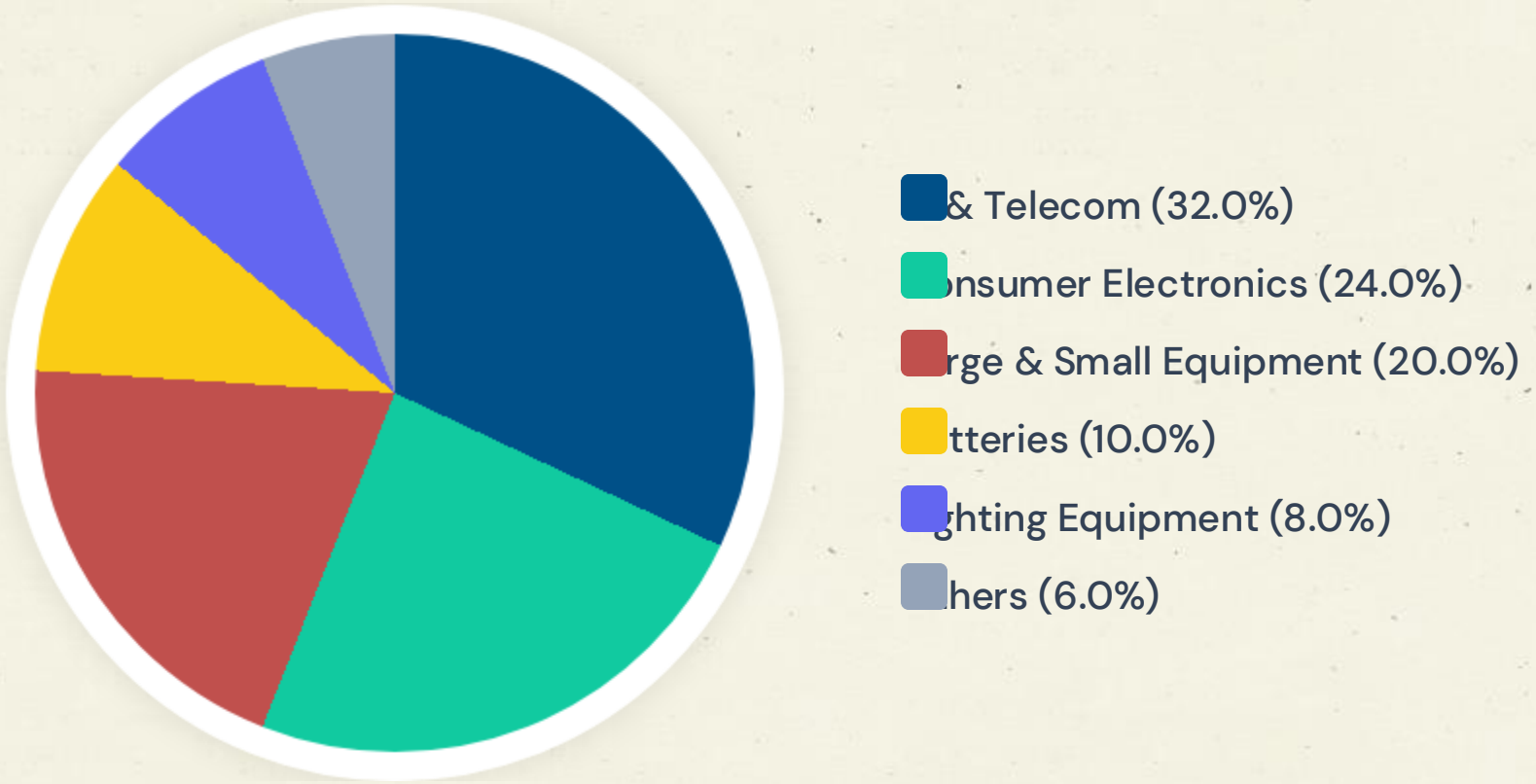
38,395.84 Metric Tonnes of e-waste generated annually statewide. Rapid growth driven by high smartphone penetration and IT-dense urban markets.

The Opportunity

75.83% Material Recovery rate achieved by authorized recyclers. A high-yield secondary supply of critical minerals and rare earth elements (REEs).

Data Source: FY 2025-26 Report

E-Waste Composition Profile



Top Generating Districts



Average state-wide per-capita generation: 1.15 kg / year.

Collection Infrastructure

Decentralized Model: Haritha Karma Sena door-to-door drives are the primary collection channel.

EPR Framework: Registered collection centers work in coordination with Clean Kerala Company Ltd (CKCL).

Efficiency Gap: Achievement stands at 62.6% against a 100% benchmark target.



The Material Adequacy Gap

22.4%

CAPACITY COVERAGE

Structural Shortfall: Current authorized recycling capacity (8,600 t/yr) covers less than a quarter of statewide generation.

Actual processed throughput accounts for only **15.29%** of total state generation, leaving massive volumes undocumented.

Compliance Tracker

Metric	Status / Value	% Achievement
Producer Compliance	8 out of 10 Registered Entities	80.0%
Inspection Efficiency	8 out of 9 Planned Inspections	88.9%
Environmental Hotspots Monitored	5 out of 6 Identified Sites	83.3%
Penalty/Show-Cause Resolution	0 out of 2 Issued Proceedings	0.0%

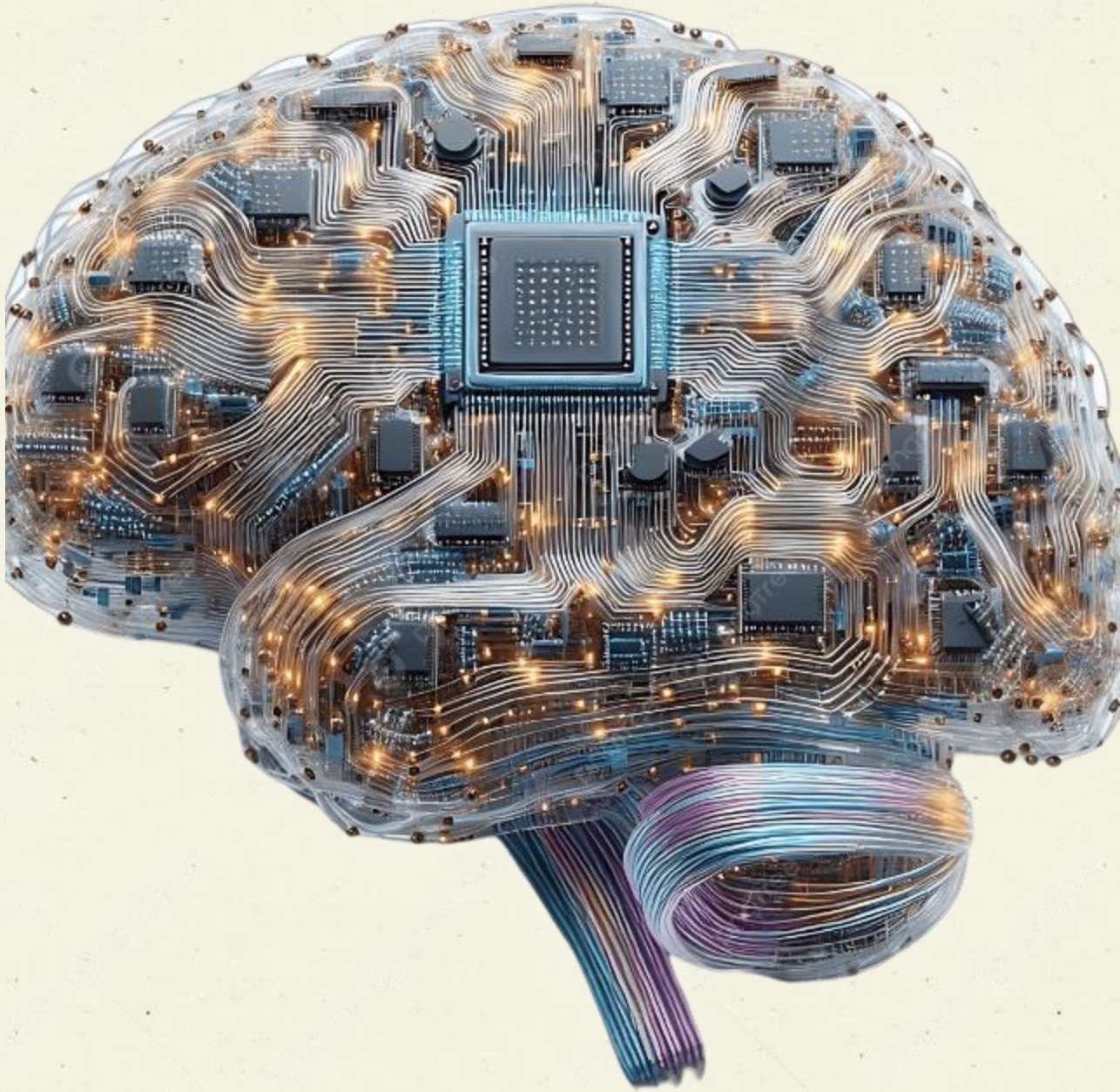
Informal Sector Hotspots

Hotspot Integration: 6 sites identified, but only 1 (16.7%) is fully formalized. The majority (50%) remain "Partially Formalized."

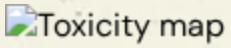
36.07%

Worker Registration Rate

The majority of the estimated 305 workers remain outside formal health and safety safeguards.



Environmental & Human Toll



Exceedance Flags:

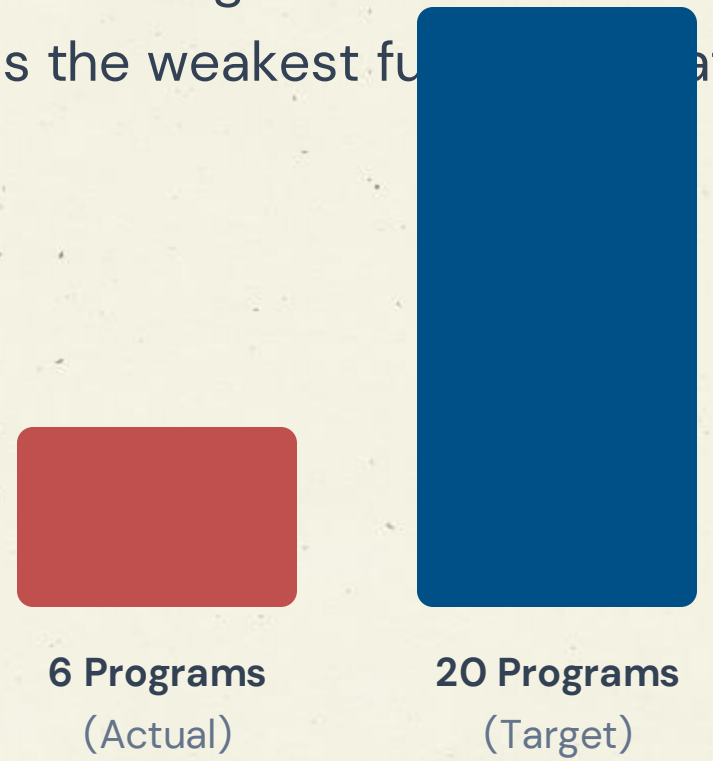
Ernakulam (Site 1): Soil and Water exceed limits for Lead (Pb) and Cadmium (Cd).

Kozhikode (Site 3): Water exceeds safe limits for Mercury (Hg).

60% of monitored sites recorded toxic levels exceeding prescribed environmental safety limits.

The Awareness Disconnect

Achievement of **30.0%** against benchmark targets. Outreach remains the weakest fu ategory.



Roadmap to Transformation

1. Formalize

Complete formalization of Malappuram and Kozhikode clusters; register 100% of informal workers.

2. Infrastructure

Expand capacity to 20,000 t/yr; fast-track authorized dismantling units in southern districts.

3. Enforce

Resolve all outstanding penalty proceedings and scale quarterly district-wise awareness drives.

Questions?

Toward an Environmentally Sound Kerala

KERALA STATE POLLUTION CONTROL BOARD
www.keralapcb.nic.in

Image Sources



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Source: en.wikipedia.org



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Source: www.istockphoto.com



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